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# ZEPTO'S MOBILE PET GROOMING SERVICE

Market, User & Financial Feasibility  
Assessment

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Company: Zepto

*“Evaluating a new service that drives trust, frequency, and long-term LTV in the pet category.”*

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Ragini Sharma

# Executive Summary

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Recommendation: Proceed with a Tier-1 Pilot

- Grooming is a high-frequency, high-trust category with strong repeat behavior
- Market is large but fragmented → clear whitespace for a brand-led player
- User research validates strong demand for hygienic, predictable mobile grooming
- Unit economics are viable even at low market share
- Strategic upside lies in retention + cross-sell, not grooming margins alone

# The Problem

## (Root Cause, Not Symptoms)

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Pet grooming demand exists – but the experience is broken

User pain points today:

- Inconsistent groomer quality
- Low hygiene transparency
- Travel + long wait times at salons
- At-home grooming leaves mess
- Mobile vans exist but lack trust & standardization

**Root problem:**

***Grooming is a trust-heavy service being delivered through unreliable systems.***

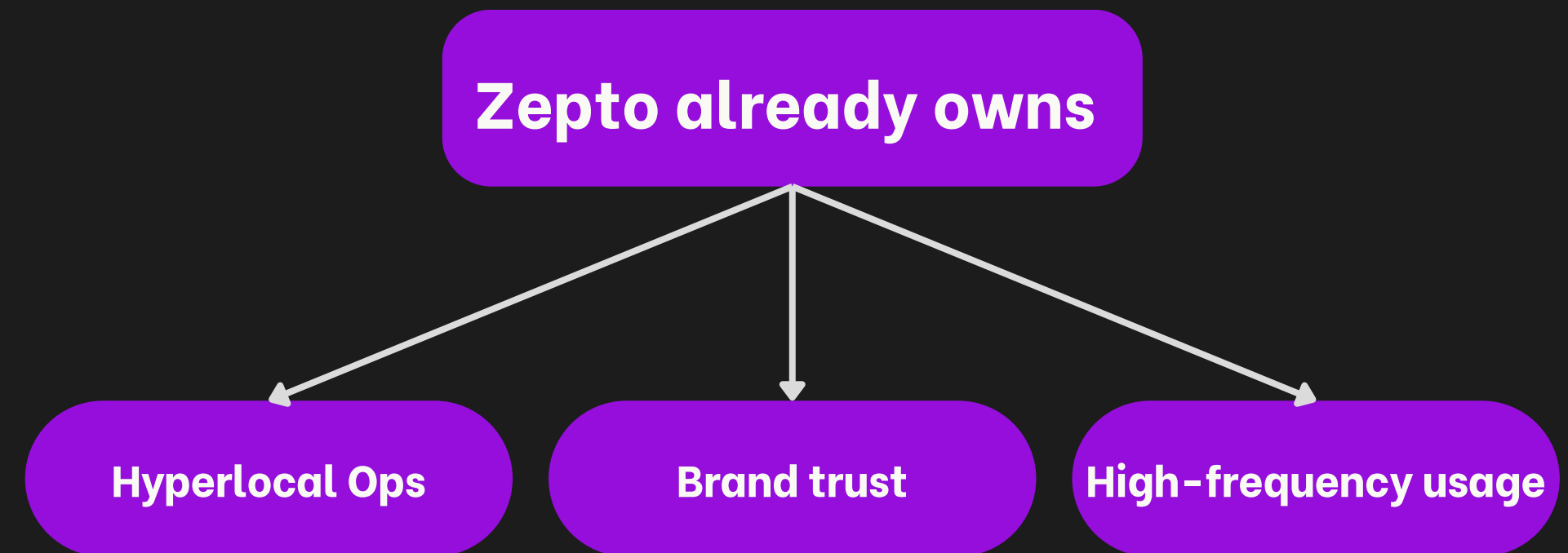
# Why This Is a Strategic Bet for Zepto?

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**Grooming creates emotional trust, not just transactions**

**Pet parents are high-LTV, repeat users**

**Strong adjacency to food, treats, hygiene & subscriptions**

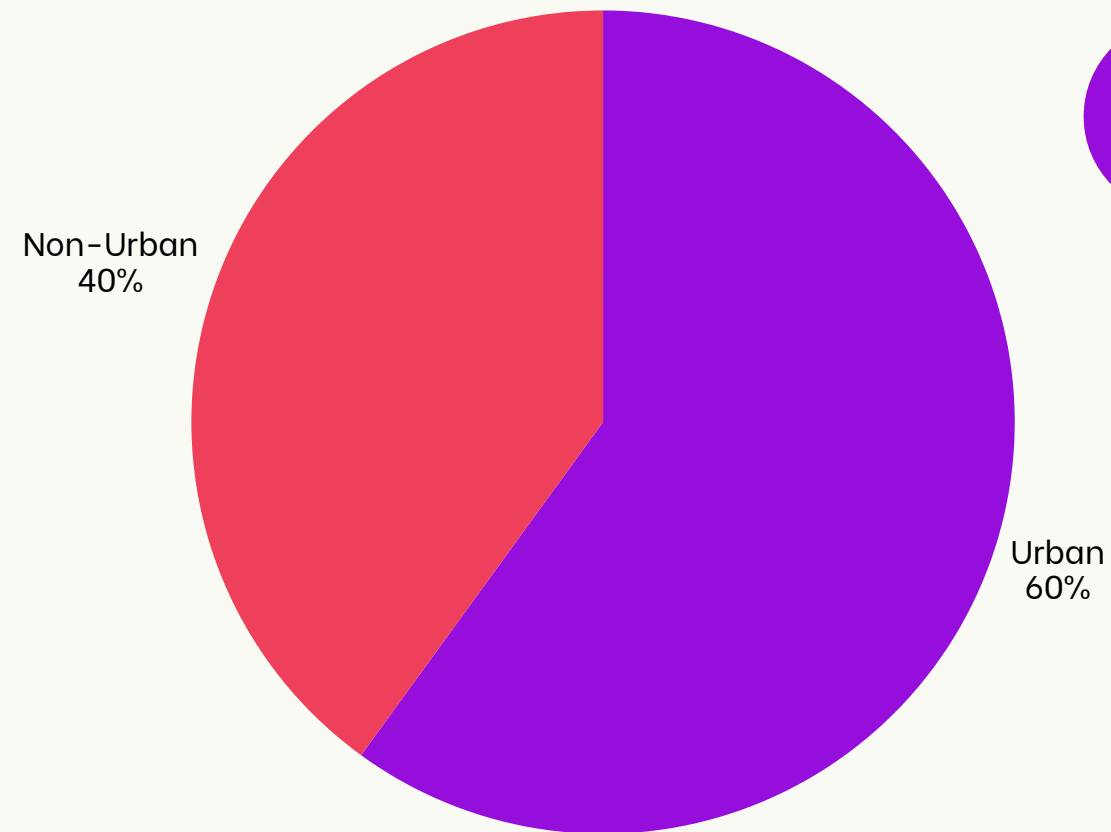


***Grooming is a loyalty wedge, not a standalone business.***

# Market Context

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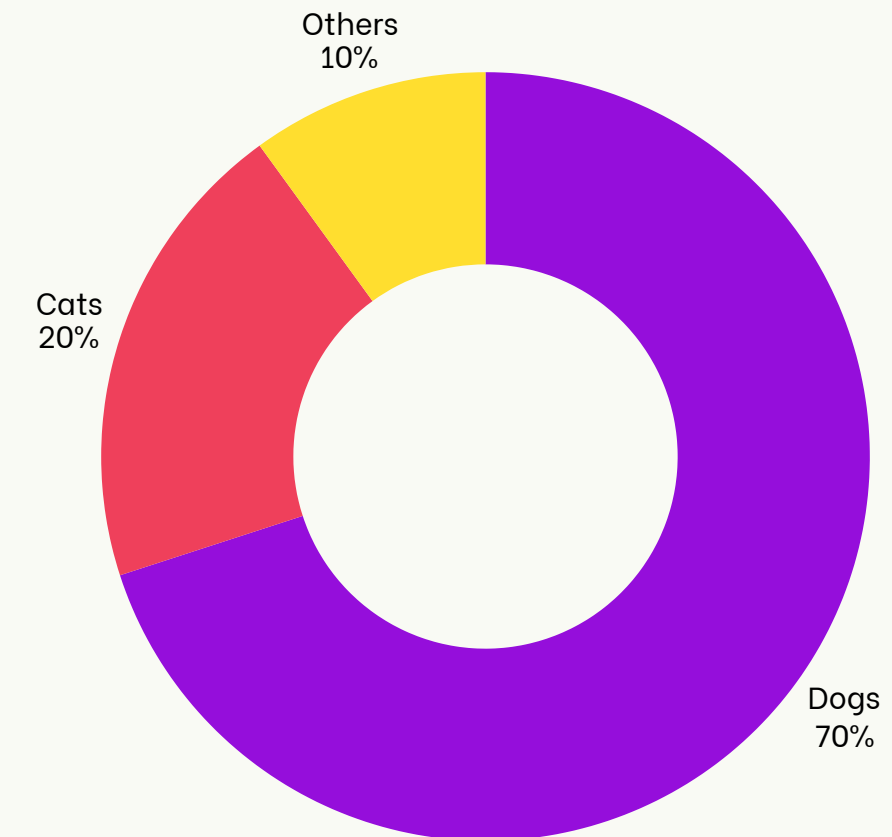
Urban Pet Ownership & Grooming Demand



India pet population



Grooming Demand by Pet Type



Grooming is a repeat behaviour having average of once every 1-2 months depending on the pet

***“Urban dog-owning households form the most concentrated, repeat-ready grooming segment.”***



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# Demand Segmentation

(Who We Start With & Why)

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## Primary Launch Segment

- Urban dog-owning households (Tier-1)
- Highest grooming frequency
  - Willing to pay for convenience + hygiene
  - Predictable repeat behavior

## Secondary Expansion Segments

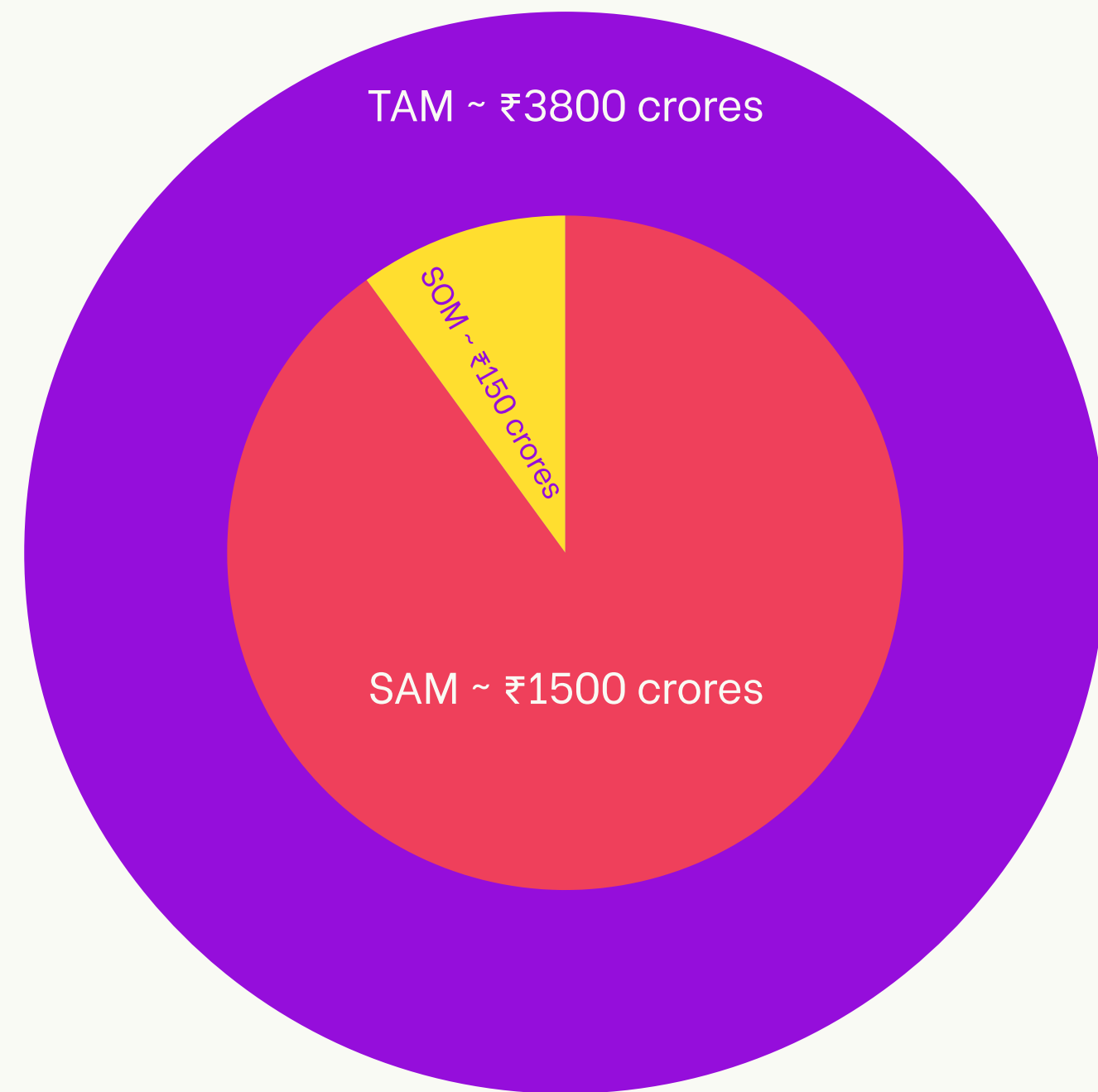
- Cats (stress-sensitive, underserved)
- Senior pets (mobility issues)
- Multi-pet households (highest LTV)

# TAM / SAM / SOM (Decision-Grade Math)

## Key Assumptions (Conservative)

- Grooming adoption: 40%
- Avg annual spend: ₹10,000

***“Even a 2–5% share creates a ₹50–130 Cr revenue opportunity with strong retention upside.”***



# Market Timing

Why now, not later

- 1 Rising pet humanization
- 2 Post-COVID preference for doorstep services
- 3 Hygiene standards now expected, not optional
- 4 Fragmented supply → low switching cost
- 5 Groomer talent exists but is poorly organized



# Regulatory Reality Check

No hard blockers identified

Risk: Execution, not legality.

AWBI & PCA: humane handling, trained groomers

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Municipal: trade license, parking, waste disposal

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RWAs: regulate access, cannot ban pets

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# Competitive Landscape

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## Urban Company

### Strengths

- Strong brand recognition
- Familiar booking experience and UX

### Limitations

- Grooming happens inside the home, leading to post-service cleanup
- Service quality varies based on partner availability

## Pet Spas (HUFT, chains)

### Strengths

- High hygiene standards
- Perceived professional expertise

### Limitations

- Requires pet parents to travel
- Long wait times and limited appointment availability

## Independent Mobile Vans

### Strengths

- Doorstep convenience
- Eliminates home mess

### Limitations

- Fragmented operators with low discoverability
- Limited trust signals and lack of standardization

***No existing player combines convenience, hygiene, and trust at scale – creating a clear opportunity for a brand-led solution.***

# The Gap in the Market

Despite multiple options in the market, **no single player today delivers the complete grooming experience pet parents expect.**

Current gaps across offerings:

|   |                                                                             |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Standardized hygiene protocols across all sessions                          |
| 2 | Predictable, reliable booking with clear time commitments                   |
| 3 | Consistent groomers that build long-term trust with pets                    |
| 4 | Brand-level accountability and quality assurance                            |
| 5 | Integrated ecosystem benefits, such as product cross-sell and subscriptions |

***This unaddressed intersection of trust, hygiene, and convenience is the space Zepto is uniquely positioned to own.***

# User Research

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## Research Methods

- Structured surveys combining quantitative and qualitative inputs
- In-depth interviews to understand motivations and pain points
- Prototype testing to validate usability and perceived value

## Participant Profile

- Urban pet parents across Tier-1 cities
- Mix of first-time and experienced pet owners
- Representation across different grooming habits and frequencies

***Research was designed to capture both behavioral patterns and decision drivers, not just stated preferences.***

# Core User Insights

Research revealed a small set of consistent, high-impact themes that influence grooming decisions.

*Pet parents optimize for trust, cleanliness, and reliability, not speed alone.*

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**Trust in groomer behavior is the primary decision driver, outweighing price or speed**

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**At-home grooming creates post-service mess, which significantly reduces satisfaction**

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**Continuity matters - pet parents strongly prefer the same groomer across sessions**

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**Product quality concerns are high, particularly around skin irritation and allergies**

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**Mobile grooming vans are appealing when they feel professional and hygienic**

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**Predictable, scheduled time slots are preferred over instant or on-demand bookings**

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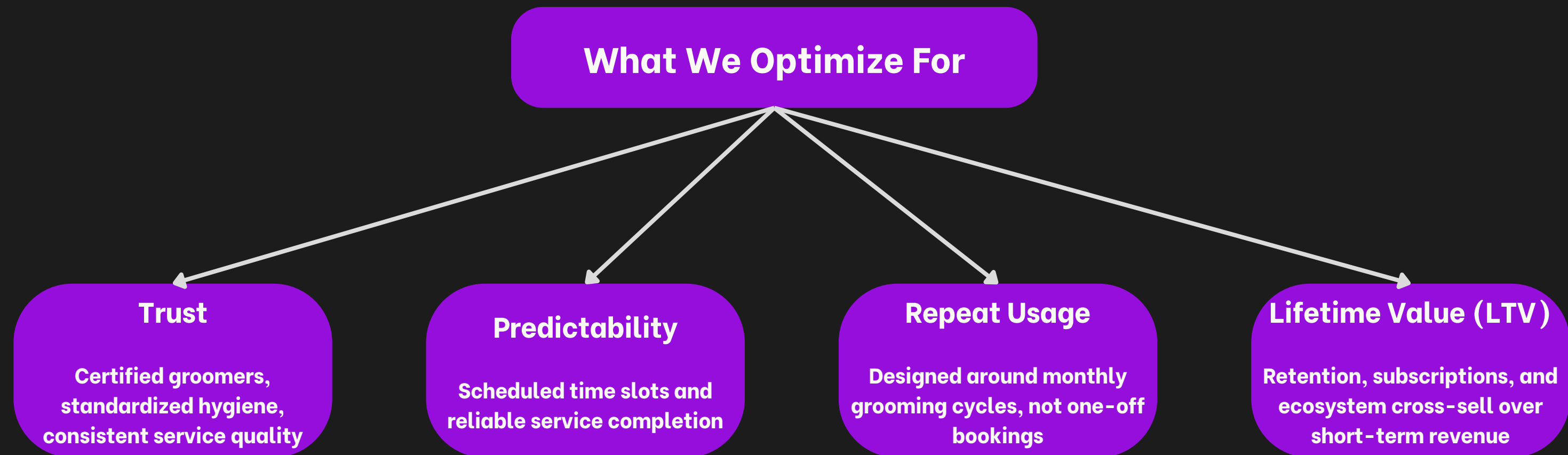


# Product Strategy – What We Build & Why

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## Core Value Proposition

“Professional, hygienic pet grooming – delivered at your doorstep, without disrupting your home.”



***We intentionally prioritize reliability and trust over instant availability or lowest pricing.***

# Solution Overview

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The proposed solution is a fully integrated mobile grooming system, designed to deliver a consistent, trustworthy experience end-to-end.

**Zepto-branded grooming vans with standardized hygiene and safety protocols**

**Certified and trained groomers, onboarded and quality-checked by Zepto**

**Preferred groomer matching to ensure continuity and build long-term trust**

**Hour-level booking slots for predictable scheduling and reduced waiting**

**Pet-safe product ecosystem, with groomer-used products available for purchase on Zepto**

***Each component reinforces the others - together enabling reliability, repeat usage, and higher lifetime value.***

# Unit Economics (Decision-Maker View)

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## Per Grooming Session

- Average revenue: ₹1,200
- Contribution margin: ~₹400 per session after variable costs

## Per Grooming Van (Steady State)

- Throughput: ~6 sessions per day
- Monthly contribution: ~₹60,000 per van

## Incremental Upside (Beyond Service Revenue)

- Cross-sell impact: ₹300–500 per active user per month (pet food, treats, grooming consumables)
- Subscription stacking: Recurring revenue through grooming + pet essentials

***Even with conservative assumptions, the service is contribution-positive and materially improves customer lifetime value.***



# Strategic Value Beyond Revenue

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While grooming is a monetizable service, its primary value to Zepto extends well beyond direct P&L contribution.

- Higher retention within the pet category by anchoring repeat, high-trust interactions
- Strong emotional loyalty built through hands-on care of a family member (the pet)
- Subscription expansion opportunities across grooming, food, and hygiene essentials
- Defensible differentiation driven by operational complexity and brand trust that competitors cannot easily replicate

***Mobile grooming functions as a long-term loyalty and lifetime value multiplier, not just a transactional service.***

# Key Risks & Mitigation Plan

| Risk Area                            | Mitigation Approach                                                         |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Groomer inconsistency                | Structured training, certification, and a preferred groomer matching system |
| Peak demand and capacity constraints | Society-level scheduling and capped daily session volumes per van           |
| Trust and hygiene concerns           | Visible hygiene protocols, transparent standards, and strong Zepto branding |
| Operational complexity at scale      | Pilot-first rollout with limited geographies before controlled expansion    |

***Each identified risk has a clear, testable mitigation plan, enabling controlled experimentation rather than high-risk launch.***

# Recommendation & Rollout Plan

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## Pilot Scope

- Launch in 1–2 Tier-1 cities with dense, pet-owning societies
- Deploy 5–10 grooming vans to balance learning speed and operational control
- Dog-first focus to maximize utilization and repeat frequency
- Society-based scheduling to improve predictability and van efficiency

## Success Metrics

- Repeat booking rate (indicator of trust and satisfaction)
- Preferred groomer adoption (measure of relationship-led retention)
- Cross-sell attach rate to pet food, treats, and grooming products

***Scale only after pilot metrics demonstrate strong repeat behavior and positive contribution economics.***

# Final Takeaway

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Mobile grooming is not just a feature.  
It is a trust engine.

When executed with Zepto's operational discipline and brand credibility, this service can become:

- A category moat built on hygiene, reliability, and consistency
- A powerful loyalty driver through repeated, high-trust interactions
- A long-term lifetime value (LTV) multiplier, enabling subscriptions and ecosystem cross-sell

**This is not a short-term revenue play, it is a strategic investment in durable customer relationships.**